Transport Planning, Development & Streetworks Management
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Transport Development Management

Memo

To: Planning Services
From: Transport Development Management
Date: 3rd February 2022

Application Number: S/COND/22/0031

Proposal: Discharge of condition 8 (Strategic Design Code) from Outline Planning Permission S/OUT/13/1555.

Location: Land North Of A420 Eastern Villages

Ed,

Condition 8:
Prior to the submission of the first reserved matters a Strategic Design Code shall have been submitted to and approved in writing by the Local Planning Authority. The Strategic Design Code shall:
a) Develop the vision, design concept, principles and frameworks described in the Design and Access Statement (February 2017);
b) Identify the character areas across the site, including the design approach, character area identity and public realm;
c) Explain how the design principles for the character areas including the local centres will be applied and co-ordinated across the site;
d) Principles to identify how a net biodiversity gain will been achieved across the site; and,
e) Set out landscape principles to ensure the green infrastructure framework (including open space) will make a positive contribution to the public realm, SuDS, movement network, the amenity of residential areas and the reduction of pollution.
Thereafter the reserved matters submissions for each phase shall demonstrate how the development

The picture of a dedicated cycle route on page 49 does not appear to have a separate provision for pedestrians, which is required.

10 parking spaces for 147 allotments appears light, especially as the allotments are located in 3 different places. Clarifity is required on how and where the allotments will be served by parking spaces. The Allotment Specification requires 10 spaces for every 20 half size plots, this is more representative of the parking demand.

The Strategic Coding Plan: Mobility (page 69) and Walking and Cycling (pages 71 & 72) - the inclusion of a 5m segregated footway and cycleway adjacent to the majority of the Primary Streets is welcomed. However, these routes then reduce to a 3.5m Shared Cycle Track and Walkway to link with the Green Bridge, existing and new underpasses. This represents a good provision through the site but does not propose good provision linking to facilities/destinations outside the site. Equally the Sports provision and school (expansion) at South Marston are destinations to which good cycle facilities are required.

Para 6.2.8 lacks in commitment by using ‘should’ instead of ‘will’. Same in paragraphs 6.3.3, 6.3.5,

The colours and patterns used in the plan titled ‘Cycling’ (page 75) but referring to footpaths are very similar, the only clarity is the Bridleway. Alternative colours and patterns are required to be used in order to determine which is which and therefore assess suitability. This is not the only plan that this issue relates to.

Page 75 – I would expect recreational routes to have been located adjacent to the open space rather than between the carriageway and the building, although there is no objection raised to the location of the recreational routes shown.

Para 6.4.3 narrowing carriageways for bus routes to 6.4m may only be considered on short (10-15m) sections of straight carriageway, subject to Swept Path and appropriate details. Example of details or the additional clarity needs to be added to this paragraph.

Para 6.4.5 – interim bus service provision may require turning heads/loops until the full circuit route is available.

Page 77 – It is unclear why the plans have the same titles but show different things, what are the plans showing please?

Para 6.5.3 refers to a 3m shared pedestrian and cycle way within the open space, whereas previous paragraphs and drawings refer to 3.5m, which is it? A 3m shared route is not acceptable.

Para 6.5.4 refers to pedestrian provision on both sides of the Primary Street either as a 2m footway or as part of a 3m shared foot and cycleway. As above and previously discussed a shared facility in this location is not LTN1/20 compliant. It would appear this paragraph and the one above have not been properly updated.

Para 6.5.5 – a target speed of 20mph is admirable, but as previously discussed a carriageway width of 6.75m to accommodate two-way bus movement is not conducive to a 20mph target speed. Visibility splays of 43m for a 30mph design speed are required on the Primary Street.

Para 6.5.6 – Where some direct access is permitted, parking in tandem along a long single width driveway is not permitted. The 'first in, first out' principle, particularly on a bus route requires side by side parking for at least 2 of the parking spaces required. *(See CIHT Buses in Urban Developments).*

Para 6.5.11 – Rural Approach Primary Street – refers to a 2m shared route, this is not acceptable. Reference is also made to a 3m dedicated cycle route, which has not been mentioned previously in the document. It would appear that this section has not been properly updated.

Verges – the soil capacity for the size and type of tree required along with the construction specification so that tree roots and soil are outside the angle of repose of the carriageway construction are required to determine the final width of the verges. A 2 – 2.5m width including trees is too narrow. 3.4m is the minimum width for a swale.

Page 85 – examples purely illustrative. NB. Modular paving will not be accepted on the Primary Street, but coloured asphalt to the coloured versions of the relevant Clause 942 material ('design mix') using a material compliant to BS 13108-5 SMA material specifications laid at a minimum 50mm thickness with a PSV of 68+ and expected commuted sum of £96/m2 (index linked from August 2020) (allows for a useable asset at the end of the 60 year development life) will be acceptable. (Commuted sum to be confirmed at S38 stage). Light coloured asphalt should be avoided.

Para 6.6.7 – As discussed, concern is raised regarding secondary streets narrowing to 4.8m, secondary streets are still serving a reasonable number of dwellings, whilst the aim of slowing traffic and creating safe crossings is acknowledged, similar treatments to those shown illustratively on page 85 are recommended in preference to carriageway narrowing.

Page 87 - locations of the examples shown are required. The illustration at the top of the page is still referring to a 3m shared way which is not acceptable.

Pages 88 – 89 – Shared surfaces: there is some indication of provision for a safe route for vulnerable users, this is essential and can be explored more at Reserved Matters stage. Consideration on the location of street furniture (primarily lighting columns) will be required (particularly for the illustrations at the bottom of both pages).

Para 6.8.8 – To reflect the Neighbourhood Plan, this should read 'will' not 'should'.

Para 6.10.5 - Reference is made to a 3m shared route, which is not acceptable. It would appear that this section has not been properly updated.

Para 7.2.6 – The width of the private drive will depend on the space required to manoeuvre from driveways. Where a single width driveway space sits abutting the private drive, the minimum distance required to manoeuvre into and out of the space is 6m.

Para 7.4.4 – This should read 'will' not 'should'. Routes immediately outside high pedestrian densities, such as schools, are encouraged to have wider footways to accommodate demand.

The Strategic Design Code is not sufficient to comply with the condition in its current form.

Please note that the comments made here represent Officer Opinion and cannot be seen to prejudice Swindon Borough Council's formal determination in relation to any application or planning matter.

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